representatives of the East India Company, writes Edward Thompson, 'now set the princes in their positions, lifting them out of the chaos in which they were submerged. When thus picked up and re-established, "the princes" were as completely helpless and derelict as any powers since the beginning of the world. Had the British Government not intervened, nothing but exstinction lay before the Rajput states, and disintegration before the Maratha states. As for such states as Oudh and the Nizam's dominions, their very existence was bogus; they were kept in a semblance of life, only by means of the breath blown through them by the protecting power.'*

Hyderabad, the premier state to-day, was small, in area to begin with. Its boundaries were extended twice, after Tipu Sultan's defeat by the British and the Maratha wars. These additions were at the instance of the British, and on the express stipulation that the Nizam was to function in a subordinate capacity to them. Indeed, on Tipu's defeat, the offer of part of his territory was first made to the Peshwa, the Maratha leader, but he refused to accept it on those conditions.

Kashmir, the next largest state, was sold by the East India